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FJ 10310/44(A)

CONFIDENTIAL:

FJ10310

JAPAN'S RELATIONS WITH CHINA.

FLAG A.

On January 22nd we received the attached photostat copy of a Memorandum handed by Mr. Dulles to Sir O. Franks on the 9th January. The Memorandum outlines the history of the Japan/Formosa question from the American point of view. It contains one mis-statement of fact (referred to in paragraph 4 below), but on the whole it is a clear statement of the American position with reasonable recognition of our own. A rather fleeting mention is made of the Yoshida letter in the penultimate paragraph.

I do not take quite so charitable a view. Mr. Dulles has been very shifty in this business. W.S. 28/1

FLAG B.

2. The meeting between the Secretary of State and Mr. Acheson at which Japan's relations with China were discussed took place on January 10th, after which telegram No. 107 was despatched from Washington to the Foreign Office. We have now received a record of that discussion (copy attached), in which the Yoshida letter is again mentioned. Mr. Dulles is quoted as stating the probable necessity of using it during the Senate's consideration of the Peace Treaty.

D. **FLAG C.**

I am sure he never mentioned it. What do they say?

3. In the circumstances I think that no further action need be taken on the Memorandum with the Americans though I suggest that we should inform Sir E. Dening in Tokyo. Draft letter attached.

4. As a matter of interest and for purpose of record there are two points in the Memorandum left by Mr. Dulles with Sir O. Franks which are worth noting:

(i) in paragraph 9 Sir E. Dening is accused of having given advice to the Japanese and implied exception is taken to this. All Sir E. Dening did was to offer counsels of prudence. (Tokyo despatch No. 339 of 17th October);

FLAG D.

[illegible] or [illegible] shall [illegible] to Americans

(ii) umbrage /

(ii) umbrage is implied at Sir E. Dening having ~~broken off (on instructions) his conversations~~ with Mr. Dulles on December 17th (paragraph 13). This was presumably because Mr. Dulles resented the matter being taken up with Mr. Acheson rather than with himself.

FLAG E.

R. H. Scott

(R.H. Scott)
26th January, 1952.

SECRETARY OF STATE

You will remember that when the United States Ambassador spoke to you about this yesterday morning, he repeated Mr. Acheson's profound apologies for the way this matter had been handled by the Americans, particularly the publication without reference to you. The Ambassador did, however, recall that Mr. Dulles had shown the Yoshida letter to Sir O. Franks and that at the meeting with Mr. Acheson you had known of the letter's existence. To this you replied that it would have been much better if the text of the letter had been placed on the table and if it could have been discussed. You would then have stated your view a good deal more strongly than you had in fact done.

C

The annexed papers show that ~~the~~ a memorandum by Mr. Dulles was seen by you on the 9th January in which, in paragraph 15, there is a reference to the Yoshida letter; and that at your meeting with Mr. Acheson and Mr. Dulles on the following day, Mr. Dulles referred to a communication which he had received from the Japanese Prime Minister.

[illegible]

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Sir W Strang
Mr Scott
Japan Dept
CM 31/1

Eden +
(sss)
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I don't remember this, my fault no doubt
E

Secretary of State

Dulles' Letter and Memorandum

The Yoshida Letter

The record of the meeting with Mr. Acheson on January 10th represents correctly the best recollections of the Ambassador, Mr. Tomlinson and myself. That is to say, we recall that the Dulles letter was mentioned but no particular emphasis placed on it and no text laid before you or discussed. I am pretty certain that you knew of the existence of the letter because otherwise you would not have felt impelled to say that "We should have preferred the Japanese to enter into no commitments until Japan had regained her full sovereignty" (Washington telegram No. 107, paragraph 4) in the instructions to Dening which you agreed with the Americans.

FJ1031/4

xx Yes. Because Ambassador tells me Dulles had spoken of it to him.
E

The Dulles Memorandum

FJ10310/20

The Embassy have been asked by the Department in a letter of the 25th January whether they prepared any notes for you on this document. The internal evidence from the photostat copy (see the numbers written in pencil against various points) suggests that they did so, but we have no copy here. This all happened, as you will remember, in great haste between the evening of January 9th and the morning of the 10th when your meeting with Acheson took place.

The Department have assumed, and I think they may be right, that this memorandum was an internal State Department document addressed by Mr. Dulles to Mr. Acheson, of which a copy was handed to the Ambassador. If this is so, (and we are asking the Embassy to check this) it would not call for any reply and it could not be argued that the fact that it mentions the Yoshida letter committed you in any way to the

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terms of that letter. This is, of course, a separate matter from the fact that the Ambassador had seen the letter itself.

Until we hear further from the Embassy I think the only action necessary is for you to approve the draft letter attached to Sir E. Dening.

30th January, 1952.